

Canon S600

The right image

The Canon S600 bubble jet printer has separate CMYK ink tanks, so you save on refill cartridges. The driver shows you the level of ink in each tank and alerts you when the level falls too low. Setting up this printer was very easy due to its parallel and USB interfaces. We used the USB port because of the hot plugability feature. Mostly silent, it does get a bit noisy while the paper feed mechanism is in operation. A 2400x1200 dpi resolution delivers near-photo quality images. The S600 took a little over 2 minutes to print text on 10 A4 size sheets, whereas the combi document of text and graphics elements took 13 minutes 48 seconds to complete printing the 10 copies. It also



supports printing on glossy paper. Though slightly expensive, this printer is ideal for DTP and design professionals.

SPECIFICATIONS:

2400x1200 dpi colour resolution, max document size 8.5 inch x 14 inch (legal) **Benchmarks:** 1 minute 39 seconds for full colour A4 size print, 2 minutes 2 seconds to print text document (10 prints)

Price: Rs 17,995

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“

Support for virtually every surround sound format and stunning picture quality puts the CyberLink PowerDVD bang in the middle of the action!

”

Mitul Mehta

Reviewer

IBM NetVista X40

Compact and functional



The IBM NetVista packs great functionality in a small package. It has a 1 GHz Pentium III processor, 256 MB of SDRAM, and an integrated 15-inch TFT display. The CD-ROM and floppy drives are integrated into the body and remain out of sight when not required. The graphics capabilities are limited by the SiS 630 chipset that has integrated graphics

Price: Rs 1,25,000

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and an onboard sound controller. The machine churned out a low score of 26 in Content Creation Winstone 2001, which can be attributed to the 5,400-rpm, 40-GB drive, the weak graphics sub-system and the low bandwidth of the SiS 630 chipset. At a price that's not compelling, you can definitely give this PC a miss.

SPECIFICATIONS:

Pentium III 1 GHz, 256 MB SDRAM, 40 GB IDE hard disk, integrated 15-inch TFT monitor, SiS 630 chipset with integrated video and sound

Benchmarks: Ziff-Davis Content Creation Winstone: 26

IBM NetVista X40		B
Performance	★ ★ ★ ★	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ ★	
Features	★ ★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ ★	

CyberLink PowerDVD XP 4.0

Great sound for less

PowerDVD XP 4.0 provides support for Windows XP and features a host of features that will take



your movie-watching experience to a new level. This software can simulate multi-channel sound from a simple stereo speaker system or even headphones. It includes support for Dolby Digital, TruSurroundXT, Dolby Headphone, Dolby Surround and DirectSound3D/A3D. It also supports Dolby Pro Logic II technology, which can simulate a surround sound environment from regular audio sources like Audio CDs. The software can merge the LFE (Low Frequency Effects) channel of the Dolby Digital soundtrack into the front speakers which lets you actually experience the low

Price: \$49.95 (shareware)

Web site: www.gocyberlink.com/english/

frequencies during gunfire or bombs exploding in movies. CPU utilisation was about 25-30

per cent on a 1.5 GHz P 4 and memory usage was around 13-15 per cent. You can download additional skins from the Internet and change the look.

This software is one of the best applications that you can use for DVD playback. Its power lies in the fact that you can experience multi-channel sound even though you do not have the expensive surround sound hardware.

SPECIFICATIONS:

Supports Windows XP, supports Dolby Digital, TruSurroundXT, Dolby Headphone, Dolby Surround and DirectSound3D/A3D

Cyberlink PowerDVD		B+
Performance	★ ★ ★ ★	
Ease of Use	★ ★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ ★	
Features	★ ★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ ★ 1/2	